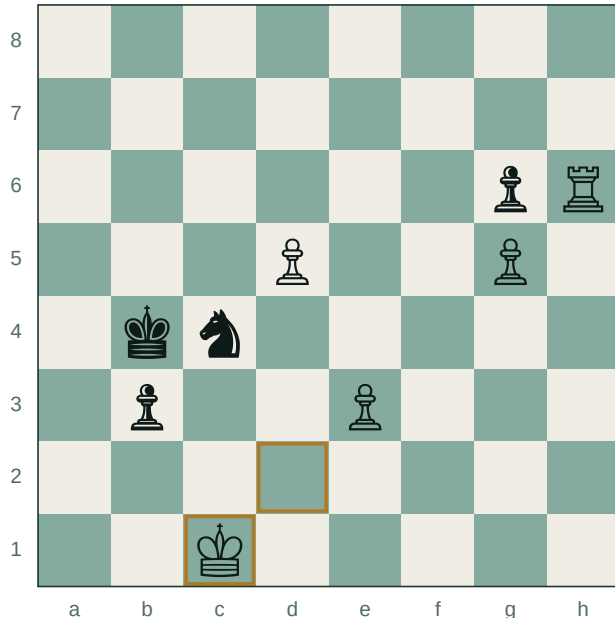


Exposed-king tactics: Black, move 45

Exposed-king tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 45.Kc1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

45...Kc3 46. Rh2 b2+ 47. Rxb2 Nxb2

45...Kc3 The king moves from b4 to c3. Recorded reply: **46.Rh2**.

46...b2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **47.Rxb2**.

47...Nxb2 The knight captures the rook on b2.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -3 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on c1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.